of the tenth Guru, Guru Gobind Singh', and the reason for this is that 'the nawab here tried to protect the Guru's sons from Aurangzeb. It isn't just revenge that the Sikhs have a long memory for. It is also for gratitude'. Although 'the RSS and the BJP' have both 'seen Sikhs as fellow Hindus', the reality, as Shekhar Gupta explained at the time was that, despite being lauded as 'the sword arm of India', the fact remains that 'Sikhs are not Hindus. They are not impressed by Hindutva. If they were, they would not have rejected Modi at his peak thrice'. As he boldly maintains, '[t]he Sikh peasantry, especially Jatts, also revel in agitation' and that '[t]his goes back to the "*Pagdi Sambhal Jatta*" movement in the early 20th century, launched by Sardar Ajit Singh'.

Shekhar Gupta ended his insightful article by connecting present-day events to the events of a hundred years ago when he reminded us of how '[i]ts slogan also became the anthem of his nephew's incredibly brave revolution' and that '[t]he nephew was Shaheed Bhagat Singh, whom everybody swears by, Left, Right and Centre'. In his view, '[t]he Sikhs love a good fight, and that's what the Modi government has given them. It won't work. You have to reason with the Punjabis'. [12] And, of course, in March 2022, the BJP lost Punjab again, winning only two out of 72 contested seats. [13]

Swearing by the name of Bhagat Singh is indeed everyone's prerogative. The question is why that should be so. As everyone knows, the farm bills were protested. It was Punjab's farmers who took the lead. They instigated the largest labour protest in human history, numbering no less than 1,25,000 protestors on the march. By their fourth week in December 2020, thousands had occupied several kilometres between the Tikri border in Delhi and Haryana's Bahadurgarh. As their ranks were fortified, Punjab and Haryana's new-found cultural unity was even expressed in musical performances, such as that of the Haryanvi Raginis, which was dedicated to the freedom fighter. [14] By February 2021, it was being reported that, with the farmers having conceded nothing, the Modi government had lost the farm laws battle and that raising the Sikh separatist bogey 'will be a grave error' because 'this BJP does not understand Punjab or the Sikhs'. [15] On 19 November 2021 the